

How to Get Ripped WITHOUT Tracking Calories

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Sep 24, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1-wHh_SNgeI Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter presents a no-tracking fat loss protocol — the "meat and veg" diet plus 20,000 daily steps — validated by his own fitness modeling career and thousands of clients, with optional supplements to accelerate results.

Contents

- 😬 Why He's Sharing This (And Why Tracking Is Still Better)
- 📖 The Personal Story Behind the Method
- 🍖 The Core Diet: Meat and Veg
- ⚙️ Why the Diet Works (The Mechanism)
- 🤢 The Adaptation Period: Feeling Terrible at First
- 💧 Electrolytes and Water
- 🚶 The 20,000 Steps Per Day Walking Plan
- 🏋️ Lifting Weights While on This Plan
- ☕ Supplement 1: Caffeine
- 💊 Supplement 2: Creatine
- li>• 💉 Supplement 3: Tirzepatide (GLP-1 Medication)
- ⚡ Supplement 4: MOTC ("Exercise in a Bottle")
- 🌙 Supplement 5: Tesamorelin
- 🩺 Testosterone Replacement Therapy (TRT)
- ✅ Full Daily Checklist and How to Measure Progress

😬 Why He's Sharing This (And Why Tracking Is Still Better) 0:00

- Brandon opens by acknowledging his audience wants to get ripped *without* tracking calories and macros
 - He calls tracking "the one thing that's guaranteed to work" and considers this method a less precise but functional alternative
 - He frames not tracking as a "copout" — his analogy: window washers dangling from ropes in Miami do something hard; entering numbers in a phone is not hard
- He now tracks religiously, carrying a food scale in his bag daily
 - "I can't imagine a world where I just put anything in my mouth"

- This protocol is what he gives to ultra-wealthy entrepreneur clients who claim to be too busy to track
 - He clarifies he only lets those clients get away with it because they paid him a "ridiculous amount of money" — for everyone else, he would require tracking

The Personal Story Behind the Method 1:33

- In his early 20s, Brandon was signed to one of the biggest modeling agencies in New York as a fitness model
 - He appeared on magazine covers, billboards, and bus ads — including a large billboard on 125th Street in Harlem
 - He modeled for Nike, Adidas, Puma, and Brand Jordan
 - He references a 2006 *Vibe* magazine (50 Cent and Eminem cover) featuring his ad for a clothing line called Academics
- The agency told him he was "too big" — not fat, just not lean enough for billboard-level fitness modeling
 - His response: that entire summer he ate *only* fish and green leafy vegetables (spinach, kale) with zero calorie tracking
 - Side effect: his chronic acne (oily skin) cleared up completely — a modeling shoot for East Bay Sports catalog skipped putting makeup on him because his skin looked finished
- He proved the method a second time later in life by expanding it to *any* meat (not just fish) plus vegetables — same result: got ripped, skin cleared up
 - Conclusion: the fish wasn't the special ingredient; the key was eating food that is not calorically dense
- He is now 44 and acknowledges the method works but would not get him to his current "elite" level without calorie tracking

The Core Diet: Meat and Veg 3:09

- The diet has exactly **two food categories** — protein/meat and green leafy vegetables
 - Plate structure: half protein, half green leafy vegetables
- Approved vegetables: spinach, broccoli, asparagus, kale — any green leafy vegetable
- Approved meats: chicken, beef, fish, bison, ostrich, goat — essentially any meat
- Eggs are also allowed (confirmed in the wrap-up section)
- **Strictly excluded:** bread, sauces, fruit, grains, or any third category of food
 - On fruit specifically: "You're fat and too lazy to track calories. You don't deserve fruit."
 - Rationale: green leafy vegetables already provide sufficient fiber and nutrients; fruit is unnecessary
- Quantity: eat as much as you want — no portion limits, no measuring
 - "I ate as much of it as I want. I tracked zero calories."

Why the Diet Works (The Mechanism) 3:32

- The key concept is **caloric density per volume of food**
 - Protein and green leafy vegetables are very low in calories relative to the physical space they take up in your stomach
 - You feel full before reaching a caloric surplus — your stomach does the counting for you
- Contrast with calorically dense food:
 - If you try to eat cookies or granola bars and stay in a deficit, you will be hungry constantly
 - Dense foods let you hit your calorie limit with much smaller volume, leaving you unsatisfied
- No discipline is required around quantity because the foods themselves are self-limiting

The Adaptation Period: Feeling Terrible at First 8:33

- Expect to feel bad for the first **72 hours**, potentially up to **1–2 weeks** depending on how carb-heavy your previous diet was
- The science behind it:
 - The body's fuel source is glucose, which normally comes from carbohydrates
 - When carbs are restricted, glucose drops and the body has not yet switched fuel sources
 - After the adaptation window, the body begins producing **ketones** (hence "ketogenic diet") — ketones become the new fuel source and energy returns
- Common complaint — "my lifts go down without carbs" — Brandon's rebuttal:
 - Reduced lifting performance is largely from being in a **caloric deficit**, not specifically from removing carbs
 - Whether you're eating carbs or not, a caloric deficit alone typically reduces energy and performance
 - Blaming carbs is a convenient excuse to quit the diet and return to candy and cake

Electrolytes and Water 10:49

- A major reason people feel bad on low-carb diets: **electrolyte loss**
 - Restricting carbs causes rapid water weight loss; electrolytes are flushed out with that water
- Solutions:
 - Drink LMNT (electrolyte supplement popularized by Andrew Huberman)
 - Brandon's personal method: a teaspoon of salt in water, multiple glasses per day; also puts "mad salt and hot sauce" on all food
 - Supplement magnesium and potassium
- **Water intake:** Brandon drinks **2 gallons per day**; he recommends at least **1 gallon per day** on this plan
- **Additional tip:** take magnesium before bed — reduces the bad feeling during adaptation

The 20,000 Steps Per Day Walking Plan 15:00

- The "next level" addition on top of the diet — Brandon warns softer viewers to stop watching before revealing this
- **Daily step breakdown:**

Time	Activity	Steps Earned
Morning (wake up)	30-minute walk	~3,000
Lunch	30-minute walk	~3,000
After work	60-minute walk	~6,000
Throughout workday	10-minute walk every hour	~8,000
Total		~20,000

- The after-work walk is social — bring family, friends, kids, or a dog
- The hourly 10-minute work walks are done by setting an alarm every hour
- **Why walking instead of running or intense cardio:**
 - Running a mile burns ~100 calories on average
 - 20,000 steps burns **100–1,000 extra calories per day** for the average person
 - Intense cardio disadvantages (especially with age):
 - Hard on joints
 - Stresses the central nervous system, potentially hurting weight room performance
 - Real injury risk — even elite pro athletes in their 20s tear ACLs just running (he references Derrick Rose)
 - Walking requires **zero recovery**, has near-zero injury risk, and doesn't impair lifting
- Tracking steps:
 - Phone health apps (iPhone or Samsung) work but are less accurate
 - Wearables on the wrist (e.g., Apple Watch Ultra, Oura Ring) are more accurate per a study he read

Lifting Weights While on This Plan 18:54

- Lift weights for **one hour** in addition to the walking
- Do NOT turn lifting into cardio circuit training — lift **heavy**
 - Heavy lifting signals the body to retain muscle mass during a caloric deficit
 - Target rep range: **6–8 reps**, where 9 or 10 would be impossible
 - Brandon personally goes heavier when cutting than at other times, especially at 44, to preserve muscle
- Two main reasons people lose muscle while dieting:
 - Not enough protein
 - Not lifting heavy enough
- Protein target when tracking: at least **1 gram per pound of bodyweight** when cutting

- Since you're not tracking here, just keep protein high by eating lots of meat

Supplement 1: Caffeine [20:28](#)

- Brandon considers caffeine **nearly mandatory** on this plan
- Two key benefits:
 - **Blunts hunger** — critical when eating a restricted food list
 - **Boosts energy** — especially needed for 20,000 daily steps while in a caloric deficit
- Brandon personally takes ~1,000 mg/day (explicitly says do NOT follow his dose — consult a doctor)
 - He reports perfect cardiovascular health on recent EKGs, full-body MRIs, and blood work every two weeks
 - Notes individual tolerance varies enormously — "some people can take a gram of caffeine and sleep at 10 p.m."
- Form: coffee, pre-workout, or any caffeine source

Supplement 2: Creatine [21:59](#)

- Brandon calls creatine **mandatory** — "I think every human should take creatine, even if you don't work out"
- Benefits beyond muscle performance:
 - Studies show creatine **boosts cognitive function and mood**, especially at higher doses
 - Recent studies in the **20g range** show improved brain health
- Dosing:
 - For muscle: **~5g/day** is sufficient
 - Brandon personally takes **20g/day** for broader cognitive and health benefits

Supplement 3: Tirzepatide (GLP-1 Medication) [23:29](#)

- A GLP-1 receptor agonist medication — Brandon started it this year (consult a doctor; prescription required)
- His experience: used it during what is normally his **most difficult** cut protocol — "the easiest cut I've ever done"
 - Mechanism: **drastically suppresses appetite** at a deeper level than caffeine or other suppressants
 - "When you're on tirzepatide, you don't think about food. You don't think about it at all."
- Personal endorsements: told his mother to get on it; a close friend lost **40 lbs** after Brandon recommended it
- He has no affiliate code or financial incentive — presents this purely as personal opinion
- Responds to critics who say GLPs are only for obese people:
 - "You don't get extra points for doing things the hard way"
 - Analogy: dieting without a GLP is like writing a report using the library and a typewriter; dieting with one is like using an iPad — that's how big the difference is

- Label language he cites: tirzepatide "lowers body weight with greater fat mass loss than lean mass loss" because it "decreases caloric intake" through appetite effects

"It was almost like a wonder drug... It doesn't get easier than this when it comes to diet."

Supplement 4: MOTC ("Exercise in a Bottle") 26:58

- A peptide — consult a doctor before using
- Nicknamed "exercise in a bottle" because it replicates some effects of exercise by dramatically increasing energy
- Brandon's personal result: reduced his caffeine intake from ~1,000 mg/day to ~500 mg/day because MOTC covered the gap
- Especially useful given the high activity demands of 20,000 steps/day while in a caloric deficit

Supplement 5: Tesamorelin 27:45

- A peptide taken at night — consult a doctor before using
- Mechanism: **stimulates growth hormone release**
- FDA-approved for excess abdominal/visceral fat (originally for HIV patients with lipodystrophy)
- Brandon's reported result: extremely visible and vascular abs — his girlfriend said "there are too many veins in your abs"
- Analogy: like taking Viagra when you don't have ED — if the drug corrects a deficiency in sick people, it supercharges healthy people

Testosterone Replacement Therapy (TRT) 28:54

- Brandon started TRT just before age 40; he is now 44
- Reason: natural testosterone begins declining around age 30 (some studies suggest age 25)
- His numbers:
 - In his 20s: natural testosterone tested at **1,200–1,400**
 - In late 30s: dropped to **400–500** (within normal range but low end)
 - Current maintained level via TRT: **~900**
- Main benefit he noticed: **more energy** (not extreme performance, since 900 is still below his natural 20s level)
- He advises young men against TRT unless medically indicated — at natural high-T levels, adding exogenous testosterone means "you just want to take steroids"
- He monitors with blood work **every two weeks** and adjusts dosage to stay near 900
- Clarifies: the original meat-and-veg method worked without any of these supplements — supplements just make it easier and better

✓ Full Daily Checklist and How to Measure Progress 31:12

- **Diet rules:**
 - Eat only meat/protein (including eggs) and green leafy vegetables
 - Eat when hungry, stop when satisfied — not a challenge, not a punishment
 - Do not eat in a caloric surplus; the foods make this unlikely but not impossible if you go overboard
- **Drinks:**
 - Zero-calorie drinks only: water, pre-workout, diet soda (e.g., Coke Zero)
 - No drinks with calories
- **Activity:**
 - Complete the 20,000-step walking plan as laid out
 - One hour of heavy lifting (6–8 rep range)
- **Measuring progress — use a tape measure, not just the scale:**
 - Measure waist **at the belly button** — ensures consistency and is harder to fake than scale weight
 - Scale weight fluctuates based on salt intake, carb intake, bowel movements, hydration — it can "lie"
 - You can weigh daily but take the **average** and don't panic at fluctuations
 - On **Day 14**: check if waist measurement is down and whether average weight trends downward
- **Why the scale drops fast at first:**
 - Initial rapid drop is mostly water weight, not all fat
 - This still counts — losing water weight makes you *look* better (same reason bodybuilders dehydrate before shows)
- **If it's not working at Day 14:**
 - First question: were you actually following the program?
 - If truly following and still not working: start tracking your calories — you've exhausted the no-tracking options
- **Action step for tomorrow:**
 - Go grocery shopping (or use Instacart)
 - Stock up on meat and green vegetables
 - Schedule your walks for the next day
 - Leave a comment committing to the plan and report back in a few weeks